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(54) **PERMANENT JEWELRY CLASP DEVICE**

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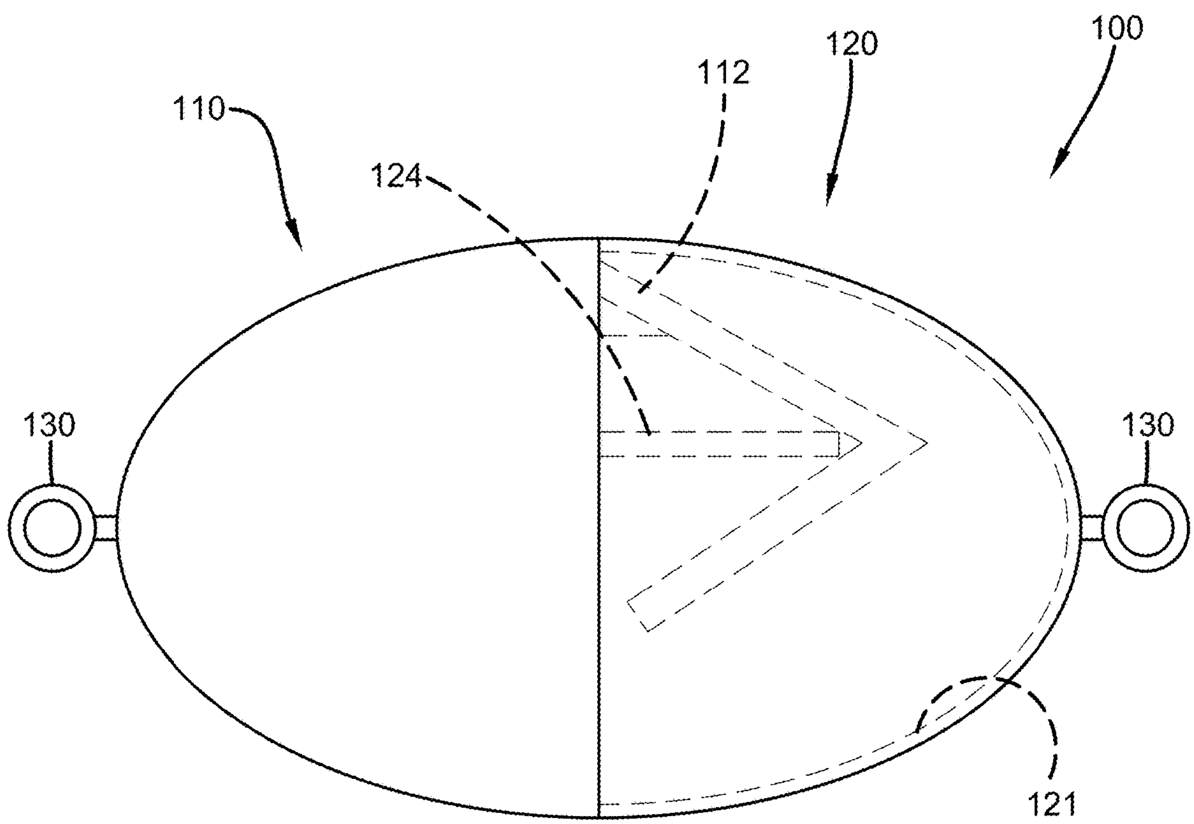
(57) **ABSTRACT**

A permanent jewelry clasp device is provided. The device is comprised of a jewelry clasp designed to provide a secure, aesthetic fastening for jewelry items such as bracelets, necklaces, and anklets. The clasp comprises two interlocking halves forming a clasp body. The first half features a compressible V-shaped fastener that contracts during insertion into an opening in the second half and expands within the interior space to lock securely against an internal fastener, preventing disengagement. To assist with alignment, the second half may include a tapered opening. Each half includes a loop fastener for attaching to a jewelry chain. A method of use involves inserting and locking the fastener within the clasp body, followed by securing the jewelry chain to complete the assembly.



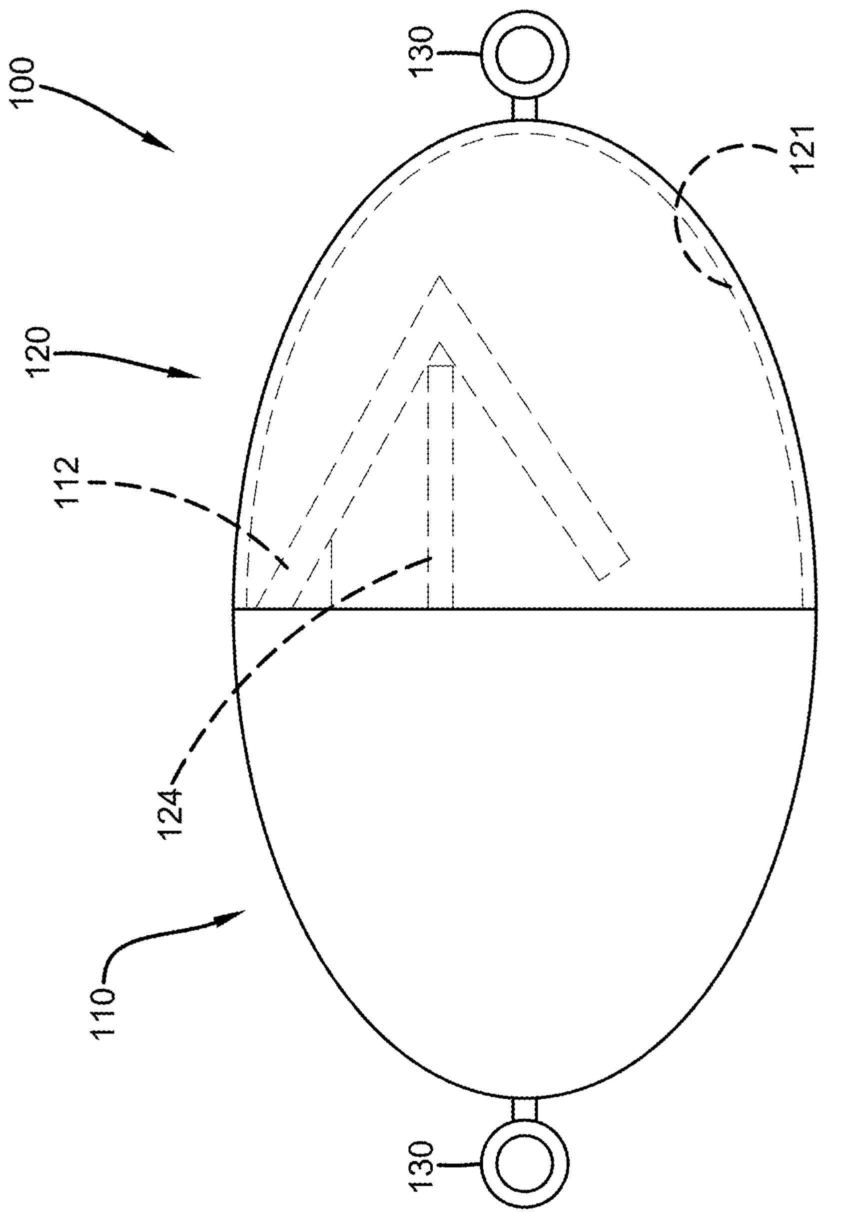


FIG. 1

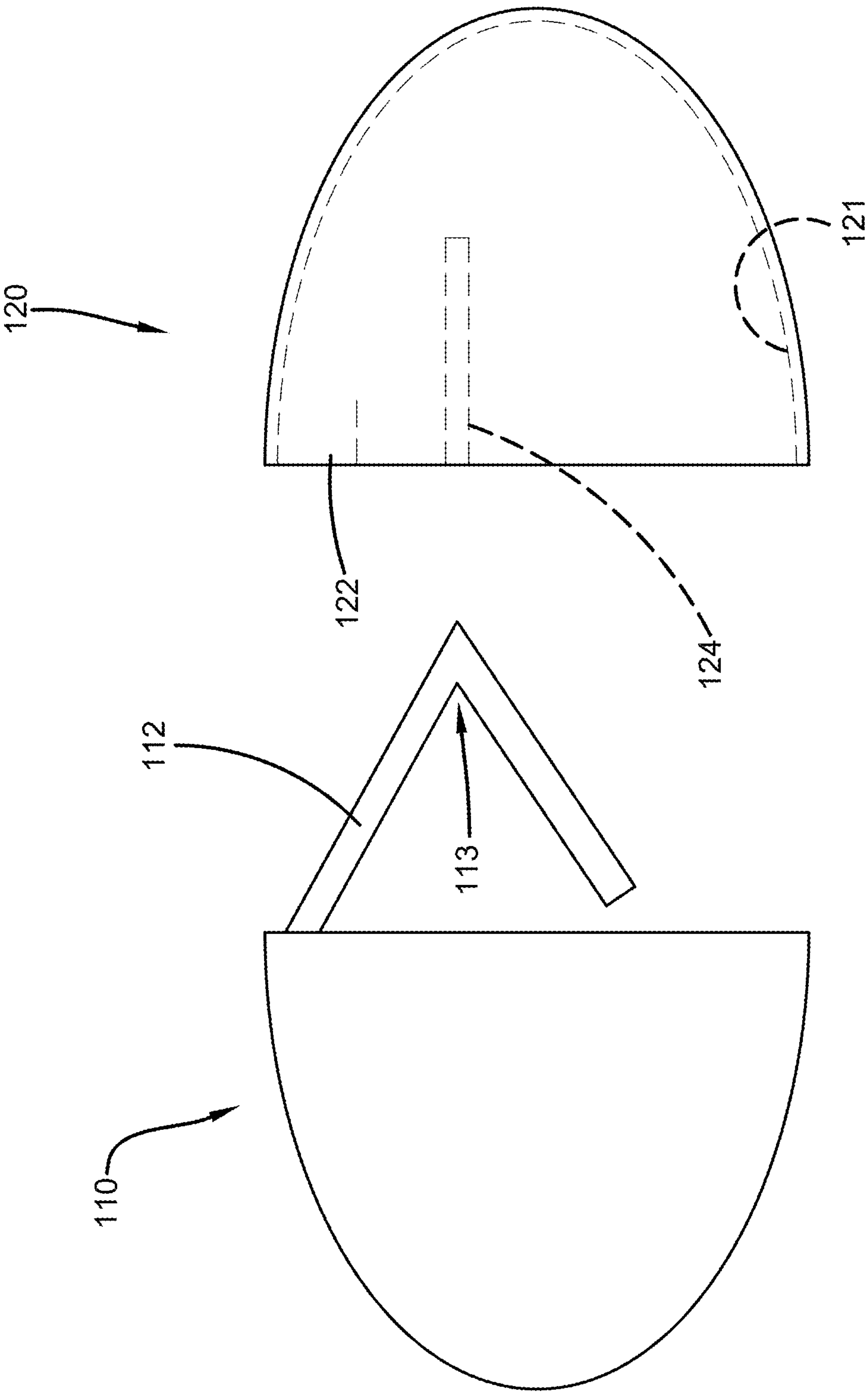


FIG. 2

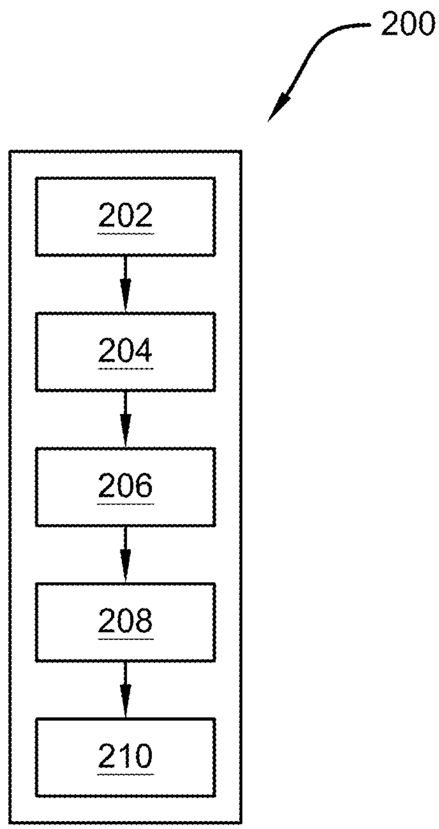


FIG. 3

PERMANENT JEWELRY CLASP DEVICE

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] The present application claims priority to, and the benefit of, U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/563,579, which was filed on Mar. 11, 2024, and is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0002] The present invention relates generally to the field of jewelry clasps. More specifically, the present invention relates to a permanent jewelry clasp with two interlocking halves, where the first half features a compressible V-shaped fastener that expands within an opening in the second half to lock securely against an internal fastener. Accordingly, the present disclosure makes specific reference thereto. Nonetheless, it is to be appreciated that aspects of the present invention are also equally applicable to other like applications, devices, and methods of manufacture.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Permanent jewelry offers an appealing option for individuals who wish to wear accessories such as necklaces, bracelets, and anklets continuously without removing them. However, traditional methods for achieving a permanent attachment often involve welding the jewelry components together, which presents notable safety risks, including burns and other potential injuries caused by the heat and equipment used. Additionally, consumers may encounter challenges in verifying the quality of permanent jewelry pieces, as there is often limited transparency regarding the durability and materials used. The availability of permanent jewelry can also be restricted by the need to visit specialized service providers, leaving consumers with few options for customization or the convenience of creating a piece at home. This situation can lead to dissatisfaction with available designs and limitations in personalization. As such, a solution is needed to enable the creation of permanent jewelry in a safer, more accessible manner without sacrificing the quality and durability of the final product.

[0004] Therefore, there exists a long-felt need in the art for a permanent jewelry clasp device that provides a permanent bond without requiring high-risk welding methods. There also exists a long-felt need in the art for a permanent jewelry clasp device that allows for consumer-level customization and assembly without requiring professional services. Moreover, there exists a long-felt need in the art for a permanent jewelry clasp device that is both aesthetically customizable and made from durable, hypoallergenic materials suitable for continuous wear.

[0005] The subject matter disclosed and claimed herein, in one embodiment thereof, comprises a permanent jewelry clasp device. The device is comprised of a jewelry clasp designed to provide a secure, aesthetic fastening for jewelry items such as bracelets, necklaces, and anklets. The clasp comprises two interlocking halves forming a clasp body. The first half features a compressible V-shaped fastener that contracts during insertion into an opening in the second half and expands within the interior space to lock securely against an internal fastener, preventing disengagement. To assist with alignment, the second half may include a tapered opening. Each half includes a loop fastener for attaching to a jewelry chain.

[0006] In this manner, the permanent jewelry clasp device of the present invention accomplishes all the forgoing objectives by providing a permanent jewelry fastening mechanism through an interlocking clasp design composed of two halves that form a permanent mechanical lock. The compressible fastener within the first half engages with an internal fastener in the second half, creating a reliable bond without heat or welding. By allowing users to lock the clasp at home, the device provides a safer and more accessible approach to permanent jewelry creation.

SUMMARY

[0007] The following presents a simplified summary to provide a basic understanding of some aspects of the disclosed innovation. This summary is not an extensive overview, and it is not intended to identify key/critical elements or to delineate the scope thereof. Its sole purpose is to present some general concepts in a simplified form as a prelude to the more detailed description that is presented later.

[0008] The subject matter disclosed and claimed herein, in one embodiment thereof, comprises a permanent jewelry clasp device designed for secure fastening of jewelry, such as bracelets, necklaces, and anklets. The clasp device comprises two interlocking halves forming a clasp body, which may have various customizable shapes and external surface finishes.

[0009] The first half of the body includes a compressible fastener, preferably V-shaped, that contracts inward during insertion into the interior space of the second half and expands back to secure engagement. The internal fastener within the second half, such as a tubular post, interacts with the fastener to create a permanent mechanical lock. Alternative fastener designs, such as U-shaped, crescent-shaped, or X-shaped, can provide multi-point locking mechanisms. The internal fastener may also vary in shape to complement different fastener designs, such as concave receptacles or crossbar structures.

[0010] To aid insertion, the opening in the second half may feature a tapered or funnel-shaped design for guided alignment. Each half also includes a loop fastener for attaching the jewelry chain, with an optional swiveling loop to prevent twisting and tangling, enhancing comfort and durability.

[0011] A method of use involves providing the clasp device, aligning the compressible fastener with the opening, inserting the fastener to secure the lock, and attaching the jewelry chain to complete the assembly.

[0012] Accordingly, the permanent jewelry clasp device of the present invention is particularly advantageous as it provides a permanent jewelry fastening mechanism through an interlocking clasp design composed of two halves that form a permanent mechanical lock. The compressible fastener within the first half engages with an internal fastener in the second half, creating a reliable bond without heat or welding. By allowing users to apply the clasp at home, the device provides a safer and more accessible approach to permanent jewelry creation. In this manner, the permanent jewelry clasp device overcomes the limitations of existing permanent jewelry application methods known in the art.

[0013] To the accomplishment of the foregoing and related ends, certain illustrative aspects of the disclosed innovation

are described herein in connection with the following description and the annexed drawings. These aspects are indicative, however, of but a few of the various ways in which the principles disclosed herein can be employed and are intended to include all such aspects and their equivalents. Other advantages and novel features will become apparent from the following detailed description when considered in conjunction with the drawings.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0014] The description refers to provided drawings in which similar reference characters refer to similar parts throughout the different views, and in which:

[0015] FIG. **1** illustrates a perspective view of one potential embodiment of a permanent jewelry clasp device of the present invention with the first half and second half is attached in accordance with the disclosed architecture;

[0016] FIG. **2** illustrates a perspective view of one potential embodiment of a permanent jewelry clasp device of the present invention with the first half and second half unattached in accordance with the disclosed architecture; and

[0017] FIG. **3** illustrates a flowchart of a method of using one potential embodiment of a permanent jewelry clasp device of the present invention in accordance with the disclosed architecture.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0018] The innovation is now described with reference to the drawings, wherein like reference numerals are used to refer to like elements throughout. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth to provide a thorough understanding thereof. It may be evident, however, that the innovation can be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form to facilitate a description thereof. Various embodiments are discussed hereinafter. It should be noted that the figures are described only to facilitate the description of the embodiments. They are not intended as an exhaustive description of the invention and do not limit the scope of the invention. Additionally, an illustrated embodiment need not have all the aspects or advantages shown. Thus, in other embodiments, any of the features described herein from different embodiments may be combined.

[0019] As noted above, there exists a long-felt need in the art for a permanent jewelry clasp device that provides a permanent bond without requiring high-risk welding methods. There also exists a long-felt need in the art for a permanent jewelry clasp device that allows for consumer-level customization and assembly without requiring professional services. Moreover, there exists a long-felt need in the art for a permanent jewelry clasp device that is both aesthetically customizable and made from durable, hypoallergenic materials suitable for continuous wear.

[0020] The present invention, in one exemplary embodiment, is comprised of a permanent jewelry clasp device designed for secure fastening of jewelry, such as bracelets, necklaces, and anklets. The device comprises two interlocking halves forming a clasp body, which can feature various customizable shapes and external surface finishes.

[0021] The first half of the clasp body includes a compressible fastener, preferably V-shaped, which contracts inward during insertion into the interior space of the second half and expands outward to secure engagement. The second half contains an internal fastener, such as a tubular post, that interacts with the compressible fastener to create a permanent mechanical lock. Alternative fastener designs, including U-shaped, crescent-shaped, or X-shaped configurations, provide multi-point locking mechanisms. The internal fastener may also have varying shapes, such as concave receptacles or crossbar structures, to complement different fastener designs.

[0022] The opening of the second half may feature a tapered or funnel-shaped design to guide the fastener for proper alignment during insertion. Each half also incorporates a loop fastener for attaching the jewelry chain, with an optional swiveling loop to prevent twisting and tangling, improving comfort and durability.

[0023] A method of use involves providing the clasp device, aligning the compressible fastener with the opening, inserting the fastener to engage the lock, and attaching the jewelry chain to complete the assembly.

[0024] This permanent jewelry clasp device offers a reliable fastening mechanism through its interlocking clasp design, forming a permanent mechanical lock without requiring heat or welding. By enabling users to apply the clasp at home, the device presents a safer and more convenient alternative to conventional permanent jewelry methods.

[0025] Referring initially to the drawings, FIG. **1** illustrates a perspective view of one potential embodiment of a permanent jewelry clasp device **100** of the present invention with the first half **110** and second half **120** is attached in accordance with the disclosed architecture. The permanent jewelry clasp device **100** is designed to achieve permanent fastening for jewelry, such as but not limited to bracelets, necklaces, and anklets. The device **100** is comprised of two interlocking halves **110**, **120** that form a generally cylindrical clasp body **102**. However, the shape of the body **102** may differ and can take various forms, such as oval, square, or other geometric shapes. Additionally, the shape of the body **102** can be designed to resemble any object, logo, letter, number, or symbol, allowing for aesthetic customization to suit different preferences and styles. The exterior surface **103** of the clasp body **102** can be further personalized through the application of various additives **105**, such as finish options that include but are not limited to polished, matte, or engraved surfaces. The clasp body **102** can be manufactured from a wide range of materials to balance durability, appearance, and hypoallergenic properties. These materials may include, but are not limited to, gold, rose gold, platinum, silver, sterling silver, stainless steel, titanium, brass, bronze, and coated aluminum.

[0026] The first half **110** of the clasp device **100** is comprised of a fastener **112** that is preferably V-shaped, as seen in FIG. **2**. The V-shaped fastener **112** is compressible, meaning it contracts inward toward itself during insertion into an interior space **121** of the second half **120** via an opening **122**. The compressible nature of the fastener **112** allows it to easily pass through the opening **122**. After insertion into the interior space **121**, the fastener **112** expands back to its original shape within the interior space **121**, ensuring secure engagement.

[0027] More specifically, once expanded within the interior space **121**, the fastener **112** engages an internal fastener **124** located within the interior space **121**, as seen in FIG. **1**. The internal fastener **124** is preferably, but not limited to, a tubular fastener or post. The post-like internal fastener **124** is positioned to engage the interior angle **113** of the V-shaped fastener **112**, effectively preventing the fastener **112** from backing out of the interior space **121** through the opening **122**. The engagement between the V-shaped fastener **112** and the internal fastener **124** creates a permanent mechanical lock, ensuring a permanent and secure connection between the halves **110**, **120**.

[0028] In one variation, the V-shaped fastener **112** may be replaced with a U-shaped or crescent-shaped fastener, which also expands outward upon insertion into the second half **120**. Additionally, the fastener **112** may be configured as an X-shaped compressible fastener, with two intersecting arms that compress inward and spring outward into multiple contact points within the second half **120**, creating a multi-point locking mechanism for enhanced security.

[0029] Similarly, the internal fastener **124** may vary in shape to complement the design of the compressible fastener **112**. Instead of a tubular post, the internal fastener **124** may take the form of a concave receptacle to accommodate a rounded or crescent-shaped fastener **112**, or it may be configured as a crossbar structure for engaging the arms of an X-shaped fastener **112**. These variations allow for different levels of engagement force.

[0030] To further facilitate proper insertion and alignment, the opening **122** of the second half **120** may feature a tapered or funnel-shaped opening **122**. This gradual narrowing helps guide the fastener **112** into the correct position during insertion, reducing the risk of misalignment or jamming.

[0031] Each half **110**, **120** is further comprised of a fastener **130** for connecting the halves **110**, **120** to a jewelry chain. The fastener **130** is preferably a loop, allowing for a secure attachment point for the jewelry chain. In one embodiment, the fastener **130** is a swiveling loop to prevent the jewelry chain from twisting or tangling during movement. The swiveling functionality improves both comfort and durability, as it reduces strain on the chain and prevents it from becoming kinked or damaged. The smooth, rounded edges of the loop fastener **130** also help minimize friction against the chain, further enhancing the overall wear experience and protecting the jewelry from unnecessary wear and tear.

[0032] The present invention is also comprised of a method of using **200** the permanent jewelry clasp device **100**, as seen in FIG. **3**. First, a device **100** is provided, comprised of a clasp body **102**, a first half **110** with a compressible fastener **112**, and a second half **120** with an internal space **121** and an opening **122** [Step **202**]. Then, the jewelry chain is attached to the fastener **130** on each half **110**, **120** [Step **204**]. However, in a different embodiment the chain may be fixedly attached to each half **110**,**120**. Then, the compressible fastener **112** of the first half **110** is aligned with the opening **122** of the second half **120** [Step **206**]. Next, the compressible fastener **112** is inserted into the opening **122** of the second half **120** by applying inward pressure to compress the fastener **112** as it passes through the opening **122** [Step **208**]. Once the fastener **112** enters the interior space **121**, the pressure is released, allowing the fastener **112** to expand to its original shape and engage the internal fastener **124**, forming a secure mechanical lock within the interior space **121** [Step **210**].

[0033] Certain terms are used throughout the following description and claims to refer to particular features or components. As one skilled in the art will appreciate, different persons may refer to the same feature or component by different names. This document does not intend to distinguish between components or features that differ in name but not structure or function. As used herein "permanent jewelry clasp device" and "device" are interchangeable and refer to the permanent jewelry clasp device **100** of the present invention.

[0034] Notwithstanding the forgoing, the permanent jewelry clasp device **100** of the present invention and its various components can be of any suitable size and configuration as is known in the art without affecting the overall concept of the invention, provided that they accomplish the above-stated objectives. One of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that the size, configuration, and material of the permanent jewelry clasp device **100** as shown in the FIGS. are for illustrative purposes only, and that many other sizes and shapes of the permanent jewelry clasp device **100** are well within the scope of the present disclosure. Although the dimensions of the permanent jewelry clasp device **100** are important design parameters for user convenience, the permanent jewelry clasp device **100** may be of any size, shape, and/or configuration that ensures optimal performance during use and/or that suits the user's needs and/or preferences.

[0035] Various modifications and additions can be made to the exemplary embodiments discussed without departing from the scope of the present invention. While the embodiments described above refer to particular features, the scope of this invention also includes embodiments having different combinations of features and embodiments that do not include all the described features. Accordingly, the scope of the present invention is intended to embrace all such alternatives, modifications, and variations as fall within the scope of the claims, together with all equivalents thereof.

[0036] What has been described above includes examples of the claimed subject matter. It is, of course, not possible to describe every conceivable combination of components or methodologies for purposes of describing the claimed subject matter, but one of ordinary skill in the art may recognize that many further combinations and permutations of the claimed subject matter are possible. Accordingly, the claimed subject matter is intended to embrace all such alterations, modifications, and variations that fall within the spirit and scope of the appended claims. Furthermore, to the extent that the term "includes" is used in either the detailed description or the claims, such term is intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term "comprising" as "comprising" is interpreted when employed as a transitional word in a claim.

What is claimed is:

1. A permanent jewelry clasp device comprising:

a clasp body comprising:

a first half comprising a compressible fastener, and

a second half comprising an opening and an interior space comprised of an internal fastener, the opening configured to receive the compressible fastener; and

wherein the compressible fastener is configured to contract inward during insertion through the opening and expand once within the interior space to engage the compressible fastener, thereby forming a permanent mechanical lock between the first half and the second half.

2. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **1**, wherein the first half is comprised of first a loop fastener.

3. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **2**, wherein the loop fastener is comprised of a swivel loop fastener.

4. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **1**, wherein the second half is comprised of a second loop fastener.

5. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **2**, wherein the loop fastener is comprised of a swivel loop fastener.

6. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **1**, wherein the compressible fastener is comprised of a V-shaped fastener.

7. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **1**, wherein the internal fastener is comprised of a post.

8. A permanent jewelry clasp device comprising:

a clasp body comprising:

a first half comprising a compressible fastener, and

a second half comprising a funneled opening and an interior space comprised of an internal fastener, the opening configured to receive the compressible fastener; and

wherein the compressible fastener is configured to contract inward during insertion through the funneled opening and expand once within the interior space to engage the compressible fastener, thereby forming a permanent mechanical lock between the first half and the second half.

9. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **8**, wherein the compressible fastener is comprised of an x-shaped fastener.

10. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **8**, wherein the internal fastener is comprised of a concave receptacle.

11. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **8**, wherein the first half is comprised of first a loop fastener.

12. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **11**, wherein the loop fastener is comprised of a swivel loop fastener.

13. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **8**, wherein the second half is comprised of a second loop fastener.

14. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **13**, wherein the loop fastener is comprised of a swivel loop fastener.

15. The permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **8**, wherein the clasp body is comprised of an additive comprised of a finish or an engraving.

16. A method of using a permanent jewelry clasp device, the method comprising the following steps:

providing a permanent jewelry clasp device comprised of a clasp body, a first half with a compressible fastener, and a second half comprising an interior space and an opening;

aligning the compressible fastener of the first half with the opening of the second half;

inserting the compressible fastener into the opening by applying inward pressure to compress the fastener during insertion;

releasing the pressure to allow the fastener to expand within the interior space and engage an internal fastener within the interior space, thereby forming a secure mechanical lock; and

and attaching a jewelry chain to the first half and the second half.

17. The method of using a permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **16**, wherein the first half is comprised of a first loop fastener.

18. The method of using a permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **17**, wherein the loop fastener is comprised of a swivel loop fastener.

19. The method of using a permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **16**, wherein the second half is comprised of a second loop fastener.

20. The method of using a permanent jewelry clasp device of claim **19**, wherein the loop fastener is comprised of a swivel loop fastener.

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